

Enough seats; what cooperation?

Learner sheet | 30 minutes | Prepared 2026-10-05

For: A discussion group familiar with the threshold and 120-seat Knesset.

Before you start: Read the system learner sheet or complete the five-minute guided route. Use the builder for the optional real-world follow-up.

Learning objectives

- Separate an absolute seat majority from confidence support and governing cooperation.
- Find a coalition's indispensable partners.
- Distinguish a shared objective, a policy conflict and missing evidence.

Your fictional Knesset (5 minutes)

Six invented lists hold 120 seats: A 46, B 17, C 11, D 9, E 7 and F 30. These are a teaching exercise, not actual parties, polls or a forecast.

A favors a common school curriculum. B favors autonomy for faith schools. C favors a common curriculum too, while D has no recorded answer. Those statements are invented assumptions for this exercise.

1. Choose two different groups of lists that reach the 61-seat absolute-majority target. Write each total.

2. For each group, remove one partner at a time. Which partners are indispensable for keeping 61 seats?

From a total to an arrangement (10 minutes)

1. Compare A+B with A+C+D. Identify the policy difference in one arrangement and the missing evidence in the other.

2. What would you ask B or D before describing a workable shared school policy? Draft one possible compromise; mark it hypothetical.

3. Distinguish cabinet membership, outside confidence support, opposition and abstention. What must be verified before deciding how a particular confidence vote would work?

4. What leadership or implementation question remains even if everyone agrees on an objective?

Test the real tools (10 minutes, optional)

Open one existing classroom scenario and the linked builder. Keep its date and recorded commitments visible. Open Compare for the same selection.

1. Record the selected poll or average and publication date. Does changing the poll change the absolute-majority conclusion?

2. Find one shared recorded answer, one difference and one missing answer. Read the original evidence before calling anything a red line.

3. Name two obstacles or compromises that arithmetic alone cannot resolve. Separate what a party actually said from your own proposal.

Exit reflection (5 minutes)

1. Explain: enough seats is a starting point because...

2. What new evidence would change your account of this arrangement?

Sources and next steps

Forming a government - legal process - See the guide's evidence dates

<https://www.israelielection.org/how-it-works/forming-a-government>

Compare - recorded answers and source dates - Current page; record the evidence dates you use

<https://www.israelielection.org/compare>

Teaching scenarios - sourced real-world follow-ups - Facts checked October 5, 2026

<https://www.israelielection.org/teach#scenarios>

Coalition Builder - selected poll and commitments - Live tool; record the selected publication date

<https://www.israelielection.org/coalition-builder>

Created for Israel Votes 2026. Credit Rabbi Daniel Bogard and israelielection.org. Teaching material: CC BY-NC 4.0; indicate changes when adapting. Source material retains its own rights.

License: <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc/4.0/>

Accessible HTML version: <https://www.israelielection.org/teach/packets/coalitions/learner>